

BOWEN SOUTH AFRICA



Bridging the Divide



Karrima Nortje

BOWTECH®
The Original Bowen Technique

Everybody Matters

WE ARE ALL CONNECTED

Like the human body, humanity is one and connected.

When one part of the body is affected, it impacts the whole. In the same way when one part of our planet is affected it ripples throughout our world.

We are as healthy as the whole...body, human race, world.

When we as individuals choose in our small ways to make a difference to our own lives and those around us, we become instruments of change and become part of the solution.



Every Body is Better with Bowen

OUR WILL AND OUR HANDS CAN MAKE A DIFFERENCE

In our world today healthcare and human wellbeing has become accessible only to a select few because of the exorbitant cost of medical care. The reality of a large majority of our world is that their longevity and quality of life will be hugely impacted by the inability to access any form of health care.

BUT FOR THE GRACE OF GOD... THERE GOES I

Our social standing in life starts at birth and will largely determine the opportunities and choices or lack of choice that we will experience.

Its easy to say we are all the same and the circumstance of our lives is only determined by our actions. Until we have no control over our environment, finances, and the actions of those around us. When external factors like our physical limitations, poverty, lack of opportunities, personal safety, governing bodies, disease, illness, etc. dictate our reality.

MY JOURNEY WITH BOWEN

My journey with Bowen started in 2008 when Jean Nortje encouraged me to do the course because my husband had perthes disease as a child and was told he would have to have a hip replacement because the of the deformed head of his femur. She told me that he will have less pain and discomfort if he receives Bowen therapy regularly. I was skeptical of the treatment until I saw how much relief it gave him and decided to do the course and for many years only treated him and close family members. My husband has not had the hip operation and is an active diving instructor/ course director and skipper who runs Pisces Divers Cape Town scuba diving center.

EYES OPENED

In 2018 I went to visit a friend of my mother's who lived in a township/ghetto on the fringe of Cape Town. My mother before she passed away in 2010 was actively involved in helping others which we as her children only found out after she died.

When I arrived at the friend's home (a very basic, small dwelling which housed her family of 4 plus extended family of 5) she said she had a migraine.

I did a Bowen session with only the BRM'S for her. She did not feel much but the next morning she called me, and she was very upset. When I asked her what she was feeling she said she was in extreme pain and feeling everything that she experienced when a car climbed a curb and knocked her a few years before.

Since then, I have worked on her addressing the accident injuries, caesarian scar from an ectopic pregnancy, damaged coccyx, broken ankle. All these injuries have never been addressed except the ectopic pregnancy because of lack of access to medical care. She does not get migraines anymore; her posture has improved, and she no longer has back pain.

THE FLOOD GATES OPENED

A neighbor of hers noticed the difference in her physical and mental wellbeing and asked if Bowen would help for leg pain down to her foot which made it difficult for her to walk. This was followed by someone who had a stroke and suddenly I was arriving at her house to a whole queue of people. They all sat outside in all kinds of weather because the lounge was only big enough to fit the foldable message bed and I could not get around it with others sitting in the room (approx. 3m x 3m).

Because of the volume of people, I am treating people without breaks unless they had strong reactions to try and fit everyone in. People were queuing from 3 hours before I arrived because I am working on a first come first serve basis and they often came from a distance away with some walking because they did not have money for public transport. This last Saturday 24th December I saw 18 people with no breaks from I arrived at 9am to when I left around 5pm with some people leaving without being seen to.

Even without the breaks I have seen phenomenal shifts and amazing results:

- From walking with tripod bent over to walking with a walking stick or unassisted and more upright,
- One woman told me no one has ever touch her body and made her feel good
- Immense pain relief after years of suffering
- Being able to sleep at night
- Rape survivors having huge emotional release and physical relief
- Domestic violence victims experiencing pain relief from their wounds
- Big shifts in quality of life with improved mobility from people who don't know what physical therapy or rehabilitation is after injuries, accidents, and victims of violence
- Etc.

These people are so grateful and often leave with tears when they experience relief after living with a condition for many years which has never been addressed. Releasing their minds from the endless cycle of their physical and emotional pain.

TEACHING HOW TO FISH

The need is great and there are many idle hands who do not have the opportunity to help shift their own reality and help those around them.

Jean Nortje has a vision of teaching people within these disadvantage communities, and she has inspired me to do my instructors to teach those who would not have the opportunity to learn the Bowen Technique because of financial constraints.

We leave behind our deeds, our example, and the lives we have changed along the way.

We as Bowen Practitioners, The Bowen Association of Australia, South Africa and the world can make a difference. Each person we enable, ripples out to a family, a community, a country, a continent and the world. Our contributions through our energy, efforts, words, inspiration, support, mentorship, advise, hands **all** count.

"I may only be one person
But I can be one person
Who makes a difference" Nelson Mandela

"Education is the most powerful weapon which
You can use to change the world" Nelson Mandela

